

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments product owner for regulated, high-stakes merchants.*

Positioning, I have shipped payments products in regulated fintech for 13 years, from a P2P payment startup acquired by Sparkasse to PSP integrations in insurance and retail.

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§ WHY UNIQPAY

UniqPay operates in the exact intersection I find most interesting: acquiring, FX, and risk for merchants the mainstream rails turn away. The requirement to handle cascading, chargebacks, and AML across multiple jurisdictions in a single backlog is not a complication, it is the design challenge. The fact that the Product Owner role is the direct path to leading the wider product function tells me the team takes the craft seriously. *That is the kind of setup where careful, outcome-focused product work actually compounds.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, API-adjacent development tasks
- **Cursor**, code review and refactoring
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, backlog drafting and research synthesis
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
- **Miro**, discovery workshops and journey mapping
- **Jira + Confluence**, backlog and sprint management

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps CI/CD, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Git/GitLab, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Django.

§ SIDE PROJECT

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Mobile group-based P2P payments, built from zero and acquired by Sparkasse.

- Split and settle flows across multiple users, with edge-case handling for partial payments and failed transfers.
 - Built inside the girocard ecosystem, which required scheme compliance and direct acquirer coordination from day one.
 - Taken from founding to acquisition inside five years.
 - Direct precedent for UniqPay's merchant-facing payment flows: the same settlement accuracy and approval-rate thinking applies at scale.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT UNIQPAY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I sit in on merchant calls and integration reviews to understand where approval rates are bleeding and where the cascade logic is under-specified before touching the backlog.

WEEK 2

Triage and slice.

I rewrite the most critical open stories with testable acceptance criteria that explicitly cover the edge cases, declines, retries, partial settlements, FX rounding, so the team can plan without ambiguity.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

I lead the first sprint review with measurable outcomes defined upfront, then convert every launch observation and post-incident finding directly into the next backlog cycle.

I COVER LETTER

Dear UniqPay team,

Acquiring, payouts, FX, and risk for merchants in regulated verticals is where I have spent most of my product career. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions in 2013 as a mobile P2P payment product, took it through scheme compliance inside the girocard ecosystem, and eventually to acquisition by Sparkasse. Since then I have run backlogs in insurance, healthcare, public-sector data, and defence AI, always in regulated environments where a missed acceptance criterion has real downstream consequences.

The Product Owner role at UniqPay asks for someone who can translate licensing conditions, KYC and KYB rules, AML monitoring, and card scheme requirements into sprint-ready stories across multiple jurisdictions. I have done this directly. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week by structuring regulatory constraints as product requirements rather than as blockers. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked across acquiring, POS, and forecourt payments in a full SAFe setup, moving research into production through a matrix organisation. Both environments required the same thing UniqPay requires: clear scope decisions under regulatory pressure, explained consistently to engineers, compliance, and commercial stakeholders in the same meeting.

What draws me specifically to UniqPay is the scope of the problem: iGaming, Crypto, and FX merchants operating across corridors where local payment methods, settlement rails, and regulatory obligations all change at once. My crypto domain knowledge is hands-on, I actively trade and manage positions across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and cross-chain bridges, and I understand the on/off-ramp and settlement dynamics that make these merchants hard to serve. That is not background reading; it is the same product knowledge your regulated merchants use to evaluate whether a payments partner actually understands their business.

I write user stories that cover payment edge cases, cascading, retries, chargebacks, partial settlements, FX rounding, because I have been burned by stories that did not. I track approval rates and settlement accuracy as primary product metrics, not as reporting artefacts. And I say no clearly when a backlog item does not serve the roadmap, which I can explain to a founder, a compliance officer, and an engineer in the same breath.

I would like to talk about the acquiring and payout platform specifically and where you see the biggest gaps in the current backlog.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries including payments, fintech, insurance, healthcare, and public-sector analytics. I run continuous discovery, turn regulatory requirements and merchant demand into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. I have shipped payments products from founding to acquisition, run sprint ceremonies as single scope owner, and applied KYC, AML, and scheme compliance rules directly in product design across multiple jurisdictions.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
- Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
- I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.

§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly data imports ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.
- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation, managing prioritisation and sprint scope across acquiring and POS payment workflows.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government, secure data platform. Identity management for the Robert Koch Institute.

- Data structures and identity management for the RKI programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

Wind energy. Full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - PRESENT

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace matching firms with workers.

- Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

IT security. Integrated hardware and software for quantum-secure encryption.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise procurement requirements. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN |
03/2018 - 08/2021

Nanotechnology and agriculture. Fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds.

- Owned financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 -
11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Owner: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, daily stand-up, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence.

Payments and fintech: P2P payment flows, acquiring, PSP integration, girocard scheme compliance, POS and forecourt payments, settlement accuracy, approval rate optimisation, on/off-ramp flows, Crypto payment mechanics.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Regulated industries: GDPR, KYC, KYB, AML, data residency, scheme rules, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, EU AI Act.

Analytics and data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Azure DevOps, Git/GitLab.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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